



Colonial Africa

This early-20th-century map shows how Africa was divided between European powers. They exploited the continent's resources to benefit industry and commerce in their own countries.

and Germany gained new colonies in southern Africa. France and Britain acquired new territory in West Africa, and Britain also built a network of colonies in East Africa running from South Africa to Egypt. By 1914, the French had occupied Morocco and the Italians had conquered Tripoli. Only Ethiopia remained fully free, having beaten an Italian force at the Battle of Adowa in 1896.

Africa under foreign rule

Although the styles of rule adopted by the colonial powers varied, in general the Europeans made no attempt to develop their colonies, exploiting them as sources of raw materials and markets for their manufactured goods. Africans were excluded from decisions that affected their lives, and European settlers established themselves in relatively temperate areas of Africa

British in Egypt

These Scottish soldiers are pictured in front of the Sphinx at Giza in the summer of 1882, just after their victory at the Battle of Tel-el-Kebir, a dispute between the British and the Egyptians over the control of the Suez Canal.



where the land was fertile, often banishing Africans from the best land.

The Europeans also brought changes to the African way of life. They imposed property taxes, and to pay these taxes Africans were forced to undertake waged labor, working on railroads, plantations, and mining operations. By forcing Africans into these jobs, Europeans caused resentment. This grew into violent anticolonial resistance, which spread across the continent in the early 20th century.

In 1904–05, the Herero of central Namibia rose up against their German rulers. In 1905, the Maji-Maji rebellion erupted in German East Africa.

In 1912, Zulus united to form the South African National Congress, which became the African National Congress, or ANC (see pp.454–55), to further the rights of native peoples. This marked the beginning of an organized movement for self-rule in Africa.

DECISIVE MOMENT

BOER WARS

In retaliation for the British annexation of the Transvaal in 1877, Transvaal Boers (below) launched the first Anglo-Boer war in December 1880. In March 1881 the British admitted defeat and granted the Transvaal self-rule. A second Anglo-Boer war was fought between October 1889 and May 1902. After a long, hard-fought struggle, the British, aided by Canadian troops, won and absorbed the Boer republics of the Orange Free State and Transvaal into the British Empire.



AFTER

After World War II, Africa's colonial rulers faced demands for self-rule. By 1978, most countries were independent. White minority rule in southern Africa lasted longer.

AFRICAN NATIONALISM

Almost two million Africans served in the armies of their colonizers during World War II. When the soldiers returned home, they yet again faced the exploitation and indignities of colonial rule. Discontent grew, and many men joined the **independence movements**, which had been increasing in strength since before the war. Most African countries gained independence between 1956 and 1968 **412–13** >>, and by 1978 European rule had almost disappeared.

MAJORITY RULE

There were long and protracted struggles for **black majority rule** in Zimbabwe and South Africa. Majority rule was achieved in Zimbabwe in 1980 when **Robert Mugabe**, leader of Zanu PF, was voted into power.

The **ANC** and the Inkatha Freedom Party (IFP) fought for majority rule in South Africa until 1994 when, led by Nelson Mandela, the ANC won the country's first multiracial elections **454–55** >>.

